Phase 1: In the Beginning

How God's Big Book works, and the first book in it, where everything starts.

At a Glance

Month	Month 1
Books covered	How the Bible works (the 66-book library) + Genesis (1 book)
Bible section(s)	Overview of the whole Bible; Law (book 1 of 5)
Big Idea	The Bible is God's one big true story in 66 books, and it starts with God making everything good and promising to fix what went wrong.
Memory Verse (all ages)	"In the beginning God created the heavens and the earth." (Genesis 1:1, NIV)
Week 1 bonus verse	"Your word is a lamp for my feet, a light on my path." (Psalm 119:105, NIV)
Little Lambs verse	"In the beginning God created." (Genesis 1:1)
Theme color	Sunrise gold and creation green
Phase symbol / badge	🌅 The **Creation Sunrise Badge**: an open Bible with a sunrise coming up out of its pages
Running total of books learned	1 of 66 (plus the shape of the whole library)

The Big Idea (in kid words)

The Bible is not just one book. It is a **library of 66 books**, and they all tell **one big true story** about God. The story starts in **Genesis**, where God made everything, and it was all *very good*. People chose to disobey God, and that broke the world. But right away God made a **promise**: He would send Someone to fix it. Then He kept His promises to Noah, Abraham, Isaac, Jacob and Joseph, and He keeps His promises to us too.

How this points to Jesus: In Genesis 3:15 God promises a child who will crush the snake's head. That child is **Jesus**. God told Abraham that "all peoples on earth will be blessed through you" (Genesis 12:3), and Jesus came from Abraham's family to bless the whole world. Abraham's son Isaac carried wood up a hill, but God gave a ram in his place. Later God gave His own Son, Jesus, as *the* Lamb. Joseph was hurt by his brothers and then saved their lives. Jesus was hurt by the people He came to save, and He forgives and saves us. The whole Bible library is about Him (Luke 24:27).

The Books in Easy Words

Before We Start: The Bible Is a Library 📚

Fact	Kid words
66 books	The Bible is like a bookshelf with 66 books on it.
2 Testaments	The **Old Testament** (39 books) was written *before* Jesus was born. The **New Testament** (27 books) was written *after* Jesus came. "Testament" means a promise or agreement.
Many writers, one Author	About 40 people wrote over about 1,500 years, but God guided all of them (2 Timothy 3:16, "God-breathed").
3 languages	Hebrew (most of the Old Testament), a little Aramaic, and Greek (the New Testament).
Chapters & verses	Big numbers are **chapters**, small numbers are **verses**. They were added hundreds of years later to help us find things. They're like the street name and house number on a map.
10 sections	Like a library has shelves for different kinds of books, the Bible has sections (see the chart below).

The 10 shelves of the Bible library (we learn all of them this year):

Shelf	# of books	Kid words	Phase(s)
Law	5	God's beginning story and His good rules	1–2
History	12	God's people in the Promised Land, kings, exile, coming home	3–5
Poetry / Wisdom	5	Songs, prayers and wise sayings	6
Major Prophets	5	Long messages from God's big messengers	7
Minor Prophets	12	Shorter messages (not less important!)	8
Gospels	4	The life of Jesus	9
History (Acts)	1	The church begins	10
Paul's Letters	13	Letters from Paul to churches and friends	11
General Letters	8	Letters from other leaders	12
Prophecy (Revelation)	1	God's forever ending	12

How to read a Bible address: `John 3:16` = book **John**, chapter **3**, verse **16**. The colon (:) means "verse." A dash means "through": `Genesis 1:1-3` = Genesis chapter 1, verses 1 through 3.

The Table of Contents trick: Every Bible has a "Contents" page near the front. It lists every book in order with a page number. If you can't find a book, flip to Contents, find the book's name, look at its page number, and turn there. *Smart Bible readers use the Contents page. It's not cheating!*

More finding tips:

- Open your Bible right in the middle and you'll usually land in **Psalms**.

- The Old Testament is the first big part (about three-quarters of the pages). The New Testament starts at **Matthew**, about three-quarters of the way in.
- Some books have numbers in front, like **1 John**. Say it "First John." It's different from **John**!
- A few books have only one chapter (Obadiah, Philemon, 2 John, 3 John, Jude), so you may see just a verse number, like "Jude 24."

Book 1: Genesis

How to say it	JEN-uh-sis
How to spell it	Gen-e-sis: **G-E-N-E-S-I-S** (3 claps)
Section	Law (book 1 of 5), Old Testament book 1 of 39, Bible book 1 of 66
Traditional author	Moses
Chapters	50
One-sentence kid summary	God made everything good, people broke it by disobeying, and God promised to fix it through one special family.
In one word	**BEGINNINGS** (the name "Genesis" means "beginning" or "origin")
Key people	God, Adam and Eve, Cain and Abel, Noah, Abraham and Sarah, Isaac and Rebekah, Jacob (Israel) and Esau, Joseph and his 11 brothers
Key stories	Creation (1–2); the first sin (3); Cain and Abel (4); Noah's ark and the rainbow (6–9); the Tower of Babel (11); God calls Abram (12); God's promise of stars (15); Isaac is born (21); Abraham and Isaac on the mountain (22); Jacob and Esau (25, 27); Jacob's ladder dream (28); Jacob wrestles God and becomes "Israel" (32); Joseph's coat and dreams (37); Joseph in prison and in the palace (39–41); Joseph forgives his brothers (45, 50)
Where Jesus shows up	The promised Snake-Crusher (3:15); the blessing to all nations through Abraham (12:3); "God himself will provide the lamb" (22:8); the ladder between heaven and earth (28:12, and Jesus says He is that ladder in John 1:51); Joseph, the rejected brother who saves his family (50:20); the King from Judah's family (49:10)
Hand motion / picture	🌅 **Sunrise hands:** start with palms together like a closed book, open them like a book, then sweep both arms up and out like the sun rising. *"In the beginning!"*

Teacher Preparation

Background for the teacher (plain adult language)

Week 1, the Bible as a whole. Many children (and adults!) have never been shown how a Bible is put together. They think of it as one long book, so it feels huge and confusing. Your goal this week is confidence. A 6-year-old who knows "big number = chapter, little number = verse" and that the Contents page is a friend has a skill they'll use for life. Bring **several physical Bibles** (ideally the same edition so page numbers match). If your church has pew Bibles, use those.

Key facts you should know:

- Protestant Bibles have 66 books: 39 Old Testament (OT) and 27 New Testament (NT). Catholic and Orthodox Bibles include some additional books (the Apocrypha / Deuterocanonical books). If a child has one of those Bibles, say kindly, "Your Bible has a few extra books; we'll learn the 66 that all Christians share."
- The books are grouped by *type*, not always by the order they were written. That's why the Contents page and the sections chart help.
- Chapter divisions were added around AD 1200 (credited to Stephen Langton), and verse numbers in the 1500s (Robert Estienne for the NT). They're helpful tools, not part of the original writing. That's why we read whole stories, not just single verses.
- Main idea: the Bible has many human authors but one divine Author (2 Timothy 3:16; 2 Peter 1:21), and one central storyline that leads to Jesus (Luke 24:27, 44).

Weeks 2–4, Genesis. Genesis has two big halves:

1. **Chapters 1–11, the beginnings of the world:** creation, the fall, the spread of sin (Cain, the flood, Babel). Key truth: God is the good Creator; people are made in His image; sin breaks everything; God judges sin but also shows grace (clothing Adam and Eve, saving Noah's family, the rainbow covenant).
2. **Chapters 12–50, the beginnings of God's rescue family:** Abraham, Isaac, Jacob and Joseph. God promises Abraham land, descendants and blessing, and that through his family *all nations* will be blessed (12:1–3). The rest of the Bible is the story of God keeping that promise, finally in Jesus (Galatians 3:8, 16).

Genesis ends with Jacob's family (about 70 people, Genesis 46:27) living in Egypt. That sets up Exodus next month.

Key truths to emphasize

1. **God made everything, and He made it good.** (Genesis 1:31)
2. **Every person is made in God's image**, so every person matters. (Genesis 1:27)
3. **Sin is choosing our way instead of God's way**, and it breaks things. (Genesis 3)
4. **God keeps His promises**, even when it takes a long time. (Genesis 15, 21)
5. **God can bring good out of bad.** (Genesis 50:20)
6. **The whole Bible points to Jesus**, the promised rescuer. (Genesis 3:15; 12:3)

Timeline and map notes

- **Timeline:** Creation → Fall → Flood → Babel → Abraham (traditionally dated around 2000 BC) → Isaac → Jacob → Joseph in Egypt (around 1900–1800 BC by traditional dating). Draw a long rope or ribbon across the room and clip pictures to it. Keep it up all year and add each phase's people.
- **Map:** Abram's journey goes from **Ur** (in modern Iraq) to **Harran** (modern Turkey), then down to **Canaan** (modern Israel). Joseph is taken to **Egypt**. Show older kids the "fertile crescent" curve on a map.

Handling sensitive content by age

Topic	Little Lambs (4–6)	Explorers (7–10)	Trailblazers / Ambassadors (11–17)
The flood (people died)	Focus on God keeping Noah's family and the animals safe and the rainbow promise. "People were being very, very mean, and God had to stop the hurting." No pictures of drowning.	Be honest that the flood was God's judgment on violence (6:11), but God gave time and a way to be saved (the ark).	Discuss justice and mercy; 1 Peter 3:20 and 2 Peter 2:5 (Noah as a "preacher of righteousness"). Compare the ark to Jesus as our safe place.
Abraham and Isaac (Genesis 22)	Tell it gently: "God told Abraham to give Isaac back to Him. Abraham trusted God, and God gave a ram instead. God never wanted Isaac hurt."	Emphasize God *stopped* Abraham and *provided*. God does not want child sacrifice (other nations did that; God forbids it in Leviticus 18:21).	Talk about it as a test of trust and a picture of God giving His own Son (John 3:16; Romans 8:32).
Cain and Abel (murder)	"Cain was angry and hurt his brother very badly. God was sad."	Name it honestly: Cain killed Abel. Talk about anger (4:7).	Discuss sin "crouching at the door" and choosing to master it.
Joseph's brothers / Potiphar's wife	"His brothers were jealous and sold him. A lady told a lie about him."	Same, plus jealousy and lying as sins that hurt families.	You can explain she tried to get Joseph to do wrong and he ran away (39:12); talk about running from temptation (2 Timothy 2:22).
Sodom, Lot's daughters, Dinah, Judah and Tamar	Skip.	Skip or summarize: "Some people in Genesis made very bad choices; the Bible tells the truth about them."	Mention that the Bible is honest about its heroes' failures; handle specifics only if asked, and privately if needed.

Common kid questions (with simple answers)

- **"Who made God?"** Nobody. God has always been. He never had a beginning, and He'll never have an end. Everything else needs a maker; God is the Maker. (Psalm 90:2)
- **"Were dinosaurs on the ark?"** The Bible doesn't say the word "dinosaur." It says God made all the land animals (Genesis 1:24–25). Christians have different ideas about the details, but we all agree God made every creature, even the giant ones!
- **"How long were the days of creation?"** Christians who love the Bible hold different views on this. What everyone agrees on is the big truth: God made it all, on purpose, and it was good. *(Teacher: don't take sides with kids; point them to their parents and pastor for more.)*
- **"Why did God put the tree there if He knew they'd eat from it?"** God wanted Adam and Eve to love and trust Him for real. Real love means there's a real choice.
- **"Is the snake the devil?"** Yes. Revelation 12:9 calls Satan "that ancient serpent."
- **"Why didn't everyone just get on the ark?"** They didn't believe Noah or didn't want to stop doing wrong. God waited patiently (1 Peter 3:20).

- **"Why does the Bible tell bad things that people did?"** Because it's true, and it shows that everyone needs God, even heroes.
- **"Why are there two Testaments?"** The Old Testament is God's promises *before* Jesus, and the New Testament is how God kept them *in* Jesus.
- **"Did God write the Bible with His own hand?"** God used people to write it. He guided them by His Spirit so that what they wrote is what He wanted said (2 Peter 1:21).

Month at a Glance

Week	Passage	Lesson title	Key point	📺 Video	🎮 Game	🖍️ Activity
1	Psalm 119:105; 2 Timothy 3:16; Luke 24:27	**God's Big Library**	The Bible is 66 books, two testaments and one story about Jesus, and I can find my way around it.	SharefaithKids "books of the Bible"; BibleJourneyTV "Bible"; BibleProject "What Is the Bible?"	Old or New? Run!; Draw Your Swords (Bible Address Race)	Bible Bookshelf Craft; "My First Bible Address" card
2	Genesis 1–3	**God Made It Good**	God made everything good and made people in His image. Sin broke it, but God promised a Rescuer.	SharefaithKids "Creation"; BibleJourneyTV "Creation"; BibleProject "Overview: Genesis 1-11"	Creation Day Scramble	Creation Wheel
3	Genesis 6–9; 12:1–3; 15:5–6; 21:1–7; 22:1–14	**God Keeps His Promises**	God kept Noah safe and kept His promise to Abraham. God always keeps His word.	SharefaithKids "Noah's ark" / "Abraham"; BibleJourneyTV "Noah"; BibleProject "The Covenants"	Two by Two Animal Match; Count the Stars Toss	Rainbow Promise Mobile; Abraham's Star Jar
4	Genesis 37; 39–45; 50:15–21	**God Turns Bad into Good**	Joseph was treated badly, but God was with him and used it to save many lives.	SharefaithKids "Joseph"; BibleJourneyTV "Joseph"; BibleProject "Overview: Genesis 12-50"	Joseph's Coat Color Relay	Joseph's Coat Collage
5 (optional)	Review all of Genesis + Bible library	**Review & Fun Sunday**	I know how the Bible works and I know the story of Genesis!	Re-watch the class favorite	Genesis Game Show; Sword Drill Championship	Passport stamping + badge ceremony

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Weekly Lessons

Week 1: God's Big Library 📚

Scripture: Psalm 119:105; 2 Timothy 3:16–17; Luke 24:27

Lesson goal: Kids will know that the Bible is a library of 66 books in two testaments, that it is God's true Word, and how to find a book, chapter and verse (including the Table of Contents trick).

Opening hook / object lesson: "The Mystery Box Library"

- *Supplies:* A box or bag holding 4–6 different kinds of books (picture book, cookbook, history book, songbook, letters/cards, a map book), plus one Bible. A small flashlight.
- *Do:* Pull out each book. "What kind of book is this? A cookbook tells you how to cook. A songbook has songs." Then hold up the Bible. "This one is special. It's not *one* book. It's like ALL of these kinds of books together: history, songs, letters, wise sayings, even a book about the future. It's a whole **library**!" Turn off the lights and switch on the flashlight: "The Bible says God's Word is a lamp for my feet and a light on my path. It helps us see the way to go."

📖 **Story script (read aloud):**

> Have you ever been to a library? A library has LOTS of books on shelves. Some shelves have story books. Some have songbooks. Some have letters people wrote.
>
> Guess what? The Bible is like a library! It looks like one book, but inside are **66 books**. Let's say it together: *sixty-six!*
>
> A long, long time ago, God picked about 40 different people to write down His words. Some were shepherds. Some were kings. One was a doctor, and some were fishermen. They lived in different places and at different times, over 1,500 years! But God's Holy Spirit helped every one of them write exactly what God wanted. The Bible says all of it is "God-breathed." That means it's God's own words to us.
>
> The Bible library has two big rooms. The first room is the **Old Testament**. It has **39 books**. They were written *before* Jesus was born. They tell how God made the world and how He chose a family and made promises. Again and again He said, "Someday I will send a Rescuer!"
>
> The second room is the **New Testament**. It has **27 books**. They were written *after* Jesus came. They tell how Jesus was born, how He lived, died on the cross, and came back to life, and how His friends told the whole world.
>
> Thirty-nine plus twenty-seven makes... sixty-six!
>
> Here's something amazing. After Jesus rose again, He walked with two friends. He explained to them what the *whole* Bible said about Himself, starting with the very first books (Luke 24:27). So the whole library, all 66 books, is really **one big story**, and Jesus is the hero.

> Now, how do you find something in a library this big? God's people added little numbers to help. The **big numbers** are **chapters**, and the **little numbers** are **verses**. When you see "Genesis 1:1," it means: the book of Genesis, chapter 1, verse 1. That's the very first verse in the whole Bible!
>
> And if you ever get lost, there's a secret helper at the front of your Bible called the **Table of Contents**. It's like the library map. It tells you what page every book starts on.
>
> The Bible is like a flashlight in the dark. It shows us who God is and how to follow Him. Let's learn to use it!

Age-group teaching tips:

- **Little Lambs:** Focus on three things: "The Bible is God's book," "66 books," and "Old before Jesus, New after Jesus." Let each child hold a Bible and find the *front* (Genesis) and the *back* (Revelation). Practice "big number, little number" by pointing on a page.
- **Explorers:** Teach them to read a reference out loud ("John three sixteen") and find it with the Contents page. Give each a "Bible address" card to find. Celebrate every find.
- **Trailblazers:** Introduce all 10 library sections. Let them race to find the first book of each section. Introduce the three original languages and the idea that chapters and verses were added later.
- **Ambassadors:** Discuss *how we got the Bible* (many authors, one Author, inspiration). Have them pair with Little Lambs to help them find Genesis 1:1 and Psalm 119:105.

💬 **Discussion questions:**

- *Little Lambs:* (1) How many books are in the Bible? (66) (2) Who wrote the Bible? (God, using people) (3) Does the Old Testament come before or after Jesus? (Before)
- *Explorers:* (1) What does "John 3:16" mean? (2) Where can you look if you can't find a book? (3) Why do you think God gave us a Bible instead of just a feeling?
- *Trailblazers:* (1) If 40 people wrote over 1,500 years, how is it still one story? (2) Which section of the library are you most curious about, and why? (3) What does "God-breathed" mean for how we treat the Bible?
- *Ambassadors:* (1) Jesus said the Scriptures "testify about me" (John 5:39). What difference does that make in how you read the Old Testament? (2) Why is it risky to read just one verse without the chapter around it? (3) How would you explain "the Bible is true" to a friend who thinks it's just old stories?

📺 **Video for the week:** | Channel | Who watches | Search term | Link | |---|---|---|---| | @SharefaithKids | Little Lambs, Explorers | "books of the Bible" | `https://www.youtube.com/@SharefaithKids/search?query=books+of+the+Bible` | | @BibleJourneyTV | Explorers, Trailblazers | "Bible" (look for an intro or "how the Bible" video) | `https://www.youtube.com/@BibleJourneyTV/search?query=Bible` | | @bibleproject | Trailblazers, Ambassadors (Explorers with pauses) | "What Is the Bible?" (series intro) or "The Story of the Bible" | `https://www.youtube.com/@bibleproject/search?query=What+Is+the+Bible` |

Teacher: preview every video first and pick the one that fits your group's time and maturity. Follow-up questions: (1) What is one thing the video said about the Bible that you didn't know? (2) What is the Bible's big story about?

🎮 **Game of the week:** *Old or New? Run!* and *Draw Your Swords (Bible Address Race)*. See Games.

🖍️ **Activity of the week:** *Bible Bookshelf Craft* and the *"My First Bible Address" card*. See Activities.

🔤 **Memory / spelling focus:** "66 books, 39 Old, 27 New." Bonus verse Psalm 119:105. Spell **B-I-B-L-E**; Explorers and up spell **T-E-S-T-A-M-E-N-T**.

🙏 **Closing prayer:**

> Dear God, thank You for giving us the Bible, Your true words. Help us learn it, love it, and follow it like a light on our path. In Jesus' name, amen.

Week 2: God Made It Good 🌍

Scripture: Genesis 1:1–2:3; 2:7–25; 3:1–24 (key verses 1:1, 1:27, 1:31, 3:15)

Lesson goal: Kids will know that God created everything good, that people are made in His image, that sin broke God's good world, and that God immediately promised a Rescuer (Jesus).

Opening hook / object lesson: "Made from Nothing?"

- *Supplies:* An empty table, a lump of play dough, a cookie (or picture of one), a mirror.
- *Do:* "I'm going to make a cookie from *nothing*." Wave your hands over the empty table. Nothing happens! "I can't. Even a baker needs flour and eggs. But God made the whole universe from nothing, just by speaking!" Then pull out the mirror and let kids look: "God made you in His *image*. That means you're made to show what God is like, a bit like a mirror shows a reflection."

📖 **Story script (read aloud):**

> In the beginning, before there was anything, there was God. No sun, no ground, no animals, no people. Just God.
>
> Then God spoke. **Day 1:** "Let there be light!" And there was light. **Day 2:** God made the sky above and the waters below. **Day 3:** God gathered the waters so dry land appeared, and He made plants, trees and flowers grow. **Day 4:** God put the sun, moon and stars in the sky. **Day 5:** God filled the water with fish and the sky with birds. **Day 6:** God made animals, big and small. Then God made something extra special: **people**. He made the first man, Adam, from the dust of the ground and breathed life into him. Then He made the first woman, Eve. God made them **in His own image**, to know Him, love Him and take care of His world.
>
> God looked at everything He had made, and it was **very good**. **Day 7:** God rested, not because He was tired, but because His work was finished and He enjoyed it.
>
> Adam and Eve lived in a beautiful garden called **Eden**. God gave them every good tree for food. There was only one rule: "Don't eat from the tree of the knowledge of good and evil."

> One day a sneaky snake (who was really God's enemy, Satan) said to Eve, "Did God *really* say that? You won't die. You'll be like God!" Eve looked at the fruit. She ate it, and she gave some to Adam, and he ate too.
>
> Right away, everything changed. They felt ashamed and hid from God. When God came walking in the garden, He called, "Where are you?" They had disobeyed. That's called **sin**. Sin broke the good world. Now there would be pain, sadness, hard work and death. And they had to leave the garden.
>
> But even then, God made a **promise**. He told the snake that one day a child would be born from the woman's family who would **crush the snake's head** (Genesis 3:15). God also made clothes from animal skins for Adam and Eve. He still loved them.
>
> That promised child is **Jesus**! He came to defeat Satan, take away sin, and one day make the whole world very good again.

Age-group teaching tips:

- **Little Lambs:** Use 7 picture cards (one per day) and a motion for each day. Repeat: "God made it. It was good!" For the fall: "They didn't listen to God. That's sin. But God promised Jesus!"
- **Explorers:** Have them put the 7 days in order. Emphasize "image of God" (everyone matters) and Genesis 3:15 as the first promise of Jesus.
- **Trailblazers:** Look at the pattern of days 1–3 (spaces: light/dark, sky/sea, land) and days 4–6 (fillers: sun and moon, birds and fish, animals and people). Look at how the snake twisted God's words (3:1 compared with 2:16–17).
- **Ambassadors:** Discuss what "image of God" means for human dignity (racism, disability, the unborn, the elderly). Compare Adam's failure in a garden with Jesus' faithfulness in the wilderness and in Gethsemane.

💬 **Discussion questions:**

- *Little Lambs:* (1) Who made the world? (2) What did God say about everything He made? ("Very good!") (3) What did God promise? (Jesus)
- *Explorers:* (1) What did God make on Day 6? (2) What did the snake say that wasn't true? (3) What did God do to show He still loved Adam and Eve?
- *Trailblazers:* (1) Why did Adam and Eve hide? What do people "hide" behind today? (2) How did the snake twist God's words? How can we spot lies like that? (3) How does Genesis 3:15 point to the cross?
- *Ambassadors:* (1) If every person bears God's image, how should that change how we treat people we disagree with? (2) Sin brought shame and blame (3:12–13). Where do you see that today? (3) Why is it good news that God came looking for Adam and Eve ("Where are you?")?

📺 **Video for the week:** | Channel | Who watches | Search term | Link | |---|---|---|---| | @SharefaithKids | Little Lambs, Explorers | "Creation" or "Adam and Eve" | `https://www.youtube.com/@SharefaithKids/search?query=Creation` | | @BibleJourneyTV | Explorers, Trailblazers | "Creation" or "Garden of Eden" | `https://www.youtube.com/@BibleJourneyTV/search?query=Creation` | | @bibleproject | Trailblazers, Ambassadors | "Overview: Genesis 1-11"; theme video "Image of God" | `https://www.youtube.com/@bibleproject/search?query=Genesis` |

Preview first. Follow-up questions: (1) What does it mean that God made people in His image? (2) In the video, what went wrong in the garden, and what did God promise?

🎮 **Game of the week:** *Creation Day Scramble*. See Games.

🖍️ **Activity of the week:** *Creation Wheel*. See Activities.

🔤 **Memory / spelling focus:** Genesis 1:1 (Little Lambs: "In the beginning God created."). Spell **G-E-N-E-S-I-S** with claps: Gen (clap) - e (clap) - sis (clap).

🙏 **Closing prayer:**

> God, You made the sky, the sea, the animals, and me! Thank You that You still love us even when we sin, and thank You for sending Jesus to make things right. Amen.

Week 3: God Keeps His Promises 🌈⭐

Scripture: Genesis 6:5–9:17 (Noah); 11:1–9 (Babel, briefly); 12:1–3; 15:5–6; 21:1–7; 22:1–14 (Abraham)

Lesson goal: Kids will learn that God saved Noah's family and promised never to flood the whole earth again (rainbow), and that God promised Abraham a huge family that would bless the world, and He kept His promise.

Opening hook / object lesson: "Pinky Promise"

- *Supplies:* A flashlight and a glass prism or a CD (to make a rainbow), or a picture of a rainbow; a handful of glitter stars or a star-patterned sheet.
- *Do:* Ask, "Has anyone ever broken a promise to you? How did it feel?" Then shine the light through the prism to make a rainbow on the wall. "Every rainbow is God's reminder that He keeps His promises. God has never broken a promise, not even one!"

📖 **Story script (read aloud):**

> After Adam and Eve left the garden, more and more people were born. But sin spread too. People became very violent and mean. It made God's heart sad.
>
> But one man, **Noah**, loved God and walked with Him. God told Noah, "Build a giant boat called an **ark**." It was as long as one and a half football fields! Noah worked for years. God told him to bring his family (his wife, his three sons and their wives, 8 people in all) and pairs of every kind of animal, two by two, plus seven pairs of some kinds.
>
> Then the rain came. It rained for **40 days and 40 nights**. The water covered everything, but the ark floated safely, because God shut the door and kept them safe inside.
>
> After many months, Noah sent out a dove. It came back with an **olive leaf**! Land was drying! When they finally came out, Noah thanked God. And God put a **rainbow** in the sky and said, "This is the sign of My promise: I will never again destroy the whole earth with a flood."

> Many years later, God spoke to a man named **Abram**. "Leave your home and go to a land I will show you. I will make you into a great nation, and **all peoples on earth will be blessed through you**." Abram didn't know where he was going, but he trusted God and went!
>
> There was one problem. Abram and his wife Sarai were old, and they had no children. One night God took Abram outside. "Look up at the sky and count the stars, if you can. That's how many people will be in your family!" Abram believed God. God later changed their names to **Abraham** ("father of many") and **Sarah**.
>
> They waited and waited. Abraham was **100 years old** and Sarah was 90 when God gave them a baby boy named **Isaac**, which means "he laughs." Sarah laughed with joy!
>
> Later God tested Abraham: "Take Isaac up the mountain and give him back to me." It was very hard, but Abraham trusted God. Isaac asked, "Where is the lamb?" Abraham said, "**God himself will provide the lamb.**" And at the top, God stopped Abraham and gave a ram, stuck in a bush, instead. Isaac was safe!
>
> Long, long after, God provided *the* Lamb: **Jesus**, born in Abraham's family. Through Jesus, the whole world can be blessed. God keeps His promises!

Age-group teaching tips:

- **Little Lambs:** Make animal sounds as the animals board the ark; count "two by two." Big takeaway: "God keeps His promises!" (Say it every time you show the rainbow.) Tell the Isaac story very gently (see Sensitive Content).
- **Explorers:** Ask them to count promises: to Noah (rainbow) and to Abraham (land, family, blessing). Have them find Genesis 12:3 in their own Bibles using the Contents page.
- **Trailblazers:** Trace Abram's journey on a map (Ur → Harran → Canaan). Read Genesis 15:6 and Romans 4:3: Abraham was made right with God by *trusting* Him.
- **Ambassadors:** Discuss "covenant" (a binding promise-relationship). Compare Genesis 22 with John 3:16 and Romans 8:32. Ask: what's harder, obeying or waiting?

💬 **Discussion questions:**

- *Little Lambs:* (1) Who built the ark? (Noah) (2) What did God put in the sky? (A rainbow) (3) What baby did God give Abraham and Sarah? (Isaac)
- *Explorers:* (1) Why was Noah different from the other people? (2) What did God tell Abraham to count? (3) How long did Abraham and Sarah wait for Isaac? What's something you've had to wait for?
- *Trailblazers:* (1) Hebrews 11:8 says Abraham went "even though he did not know where he was going." What makes that kind of trust possible? (2) How is the ark like Jesus? (3) Why do you think God made Abraham wait so long?
- *Ambassadors:* (1) What does Genesis 15:6 teach about faith and being right with God? (2) Genesis 22 is a hard chapter. How does it help us understand what God did for us at the cross? (3) The Tower of Babel was people trying to "make a name for ourselves" (11:4); God instead promises to make Abram's name great (12:2). What's the difference?

📺 **Video for the week:** | Channel | Who watches | Search term | Link | |---|---|---|---| | @SharefaithKids | Little Lambs, Explorers | "Noah's ark" or "Abraham" | `https://www.youtube.com/@SharefaithKids/search?query=Noah` | | @BibleJourneyTV | Explorers, Trailblazers | "Noah" or "Abraham" | `https://www.youtube.com/@BibleJourneyTV/search?query=Noah` | | @bibleproject | Trailblazers, Ambassadors | Theme video "The Covenants"; or the second half of "Overview: Genesis 1-11" | `https://www.youtube.com/@bibleproject/search?query=Covenants` |

Preview first. Follow-up questions: (1) What promise did God make in the video? (2) How did God keep it?

🎮 **Game of the week:** *Two by Two Animal Match* and *Count the Stars Toss*. See Games.

🖍️ **Activity of the week:** *Rainbow Promise Mobile* (younger) or *Abraham's Star Jar* (older). See Activities.

🔤 **Memory / spelling focus:** Keep reviewing Genesis 1:1. Spell **N-O-A-H** and **A-B-R-A-H-A-M** (Explorers+). Trailblazers: **C-O-V-E-N-A-N-T**.

🙏 **Closing prayer:**

> Faithful God, You always keep Your promises. When we have to wait, help us trust You like Abraham did. Thank You for Jesus, the Lamb You provided for us. Amen.

Week 4: God Turns Bad into Good 🧥

Scripture: Genesis 25:19–34 and 28:10–22 (Jacob, briefly); 37; 39–45; 50:15–21 (key verse 50:20)

Lesson goal: Kids will learn how God was with Joseph through hard times and used even the wrong things people did to save many lives, and how Joseph forgave.

Opening hook / object lesson: "Messy Becomes Beautiful"

- *Supplies:* A piece of paper with random scribbles and splotches on it, prepared in advance so that, with a few added lines, the scribbles become a picture (for example a butterfly or a flower). Markers.
- *Do:* Show the messy page: "What a mess! Is this good for anything?" Then quickly add a few lines to turn the mess into a picture. "Sometimes our lives feel messy. But God can take messy, even mean things that happen, and make something good. That's Joseph's story."

📖 **Story script (read aloud):**

> Abraham's son Isaac had twin boys, **Esau** and **Jacob**. Jacob tricked his brother and had to run away, but God still met him. One night Jacob dreamed of a **stairway to heaven** with angels going up and down, and God promised to be with him. Later God gave Jacob a new name: **Israel**. Jacob had **12 sons**!

> Jacob loved his son **Joseph** most and gave him a beautiful, fancy **robe**, a coat of many colors. Joseph also had dreams: his brothers' bundles of grain bowed down to his! His brothers got jealous. Very jealous.
>
> One day, when Joseph went to check on them in the fields, they grabbed him, took his robe, and threw him into a dry well. Then they **sold him** to traders going to Egypt for 20 pieces of silver! They dipped his coat in goat's blood and told their dad, "A wild animal must have gotten him." Jacob cried and cried.
>
> In Egypt, Joseph became a servant in the house of a man named Potiphar. Joseph worked hard, and **the LORD was with Joseph**. But Potiphar's wife told a lie about Joseph, and he was thrown into **prison**, even though he did nothing wrong. Still, **the LORD was with Joseph**.
>
> In prison, God helped Joseph explain dreams. One day **Pharaoh**, the king of Egypt, had two strange dreams: seven fat cows eaten by seven skinny cows, and seven good heads of grain swallowed by seven thin ones. Nobody knew what they meant. But Joseph said, "God will tell you: seven years of lots of food are coming, and then seven years of famine (no food)." Pharaoh put Joseph in charge of all of Egypt! Joseph was 30 years old.
>
> When the famine came, Joseph's brothers traveled to Egypt to buy food, and they bowed down to him, just like the dream! They didn't recognize him. Joseph tested them to see if they had changed. Then he cried and said, "I am Joseph!" They were scared. But Joseph **forgave** them. He hugged them and brought the whole family to Egypt.
>
> Joseph told them, "You meant to hurt me, but **God meant it for good**, to save many lives."
>
> Jesus is like Joseph, only even greater. He was rejected and hurt by people He loved. But God used His death on the cross to save many, many lives, and Jesus forgives everyone who comes to Him.

Age-group teaching tips:

- **Little Lambs:** Use a colorful scarf or robe as a prop. Repeat the refrain: "But God was with Joseph!" each time something bad happens. Kids can shout it with you.
- **Explorers:** Make a "Bad → God → Good" chart: sold → God was with him → became a leader; jailed → God gave wisdom → saved Egypt. Practice forgiveness role-plays.
- **Trailblazers:** Track Joseph's age (17 when sold, 37:2; 30 before Pharaoh, 41:46). Discuss how God's plan protected the family line that leads to Jesus (49:10).
- **Ambassadors:** Discuss Genesis 50:20 and Romans 8:28. Does "God meant it for good" make evil okay? (No. The brothers were still guilty; God is greater than their evil.) Talk about forgiveness versus pretending nothing happened.

💬 **Discussion questions:**

- *Little Lambs:* (1) What special gift did Joseph's dad give him? (A colorful coat) (2) Was God with Joseph in the prison? (Yes!) (3) What did Joseph do when he saw his brothers? (He forgave them)

- *Explorers:* (1) Why were Joseph's brothers jealous? (2) How did God help Joseph in prison? (3) Is it easy or hard to forgive someone? Why?
- *Trailblazers:* (1) Joseph tested his brothers before revealing himself. Why? (2) Which character do you relate to most: Jacob, Joseph or the brothers? Why? (3) How does Joseph's story show God working when no one could see Him?
- *Ambassadors:* (1) Romans 8:28 and Genesis 50:20 are often quoted. What do they promise, and what don't they promise? (2) What can we learn from Joseph about integrity when no one is watching (Genesis 39)? (3) How is Joseph a "preview" of Jesus? List at least three parallels.

📺 **Video for the week:** | Channel | Who watches | Search term | Link | |---|---|---|---| | @SharefaithKids | Little Lambs, Explorers | "Joseph" | `https://www.youtube.com/@SharefaithKids/search?query=Joseph` | | @BibleJourneyTV | Explorers, Trailblazers | "Joseph" or "Jacob" | `https://www.youtube.com/@BibleJourneyTV/search?query=Joseph` | | @bibleproject | Trailblazers, Ambassadors | "Overview: Genesis 12-50" | `https://www.youtube.com/@bibleproject/search?query=Genesis+12-50` |

Preview first. Follow-up questions: (1) What bad things happened to Joseph, and what good did God bring? (2) What does Joseph teach us about forgiving?

🎮 **Game of the week:** *Joseph's Coat Color Relay*. See Games.

🖍️ **Activity of the week:** *Joseph's Coat Collage*. See Activities.

🔤 **Memory / spelling focus:** Say Genesis 1:1 from memory (all groups) and spell **G-E-N-E-S-I-S** without help. Explorers+: spell **J-O-S-E-P-H**, **J-A-C-O-B**, **I-S-A-A-C**.

🙏 **Closing prayer:**

> Dear God, thank You that You are always with us, even on bad days. Help us forgive like Joseph did, and like Jesus forgives us. We trust You to bring good out of hard things. Amen.

Week 5 (optional): Review & Fun Sunday 🎉

Use the **End-of-Phase Review & Celebration** plan below: Genesis Game Show, Sword Drill Championship, oral check-offs, Bible Passport stamps and badges.

Book Memory Song & Motions 🎵

This is the **first** song of the year. Every later phase adds new verses to it, so teach it well!

Part A: "The Bible Library Song" (tune: *Twinkle, Twinkle, Little Star*)

> 🎵 **Sixty-six books, one big story,** *(hold up 6 fingers, then 6 again; spread arms wide)* **All about God and all His glory!** *(point up, then wiggle fingers down like sparkles)* **Thirty-nine are in the Old,**

> *(thumb points back over shoulder = "before Jesus")* **Twenty-seven New, we're told.** *(thumb points forward = "after Jesus")* **Sixty-six books, one big story, All about God and all His glory!**

Part B: "Genesis Is Book Number One" (same tune)

> 🎵 **Genesis is book number one,** *(hold up 1 finger)* **That's where God's big story's begun!** *(Sunrise hands: open the "book," sweep arms up like the sun)* **G-E-N-E-S-I-S,** *(draw each letter in the air, or clap 7 times)* **God made it all, and it was blessed!** *(arms in a big circle = the world)* **Genesis is book number one, First of the LAW, and we've begun!** *(fist pump on "LAW!")*

Part C: "Find It Fast" chant (call and response, steady clap)

> **Teacher:** Big number? **Kids:** CHAPTER! **Teacher:** Little number? **Kids:** VERSE! **Teacher:** Lost your place? **Kids:** Contents FIRST! **Teacher:** Old Testament? **Kids:** BEFORE Jesus! **Teacher:** New Testament? **Kids:** AFTER Jesus! **Teacher:** How many books? **Kids:** SIXTY-SIX!

Hand motion for Genesis

🌅 **Sunrise hands:** palms pressed together (a closed book) → open them like a book → sweep both arms up and out in a big arc like the sun rising. Say: *"Genesis: in the beginning!"*

Section Shout

> **Teacher:** "What's the first section of the Bible library?" **Kids:** "**LAW!** Five books of LAW! Book one: **GENESIS!**" *(hold up 5 fingers, then 1)*

(Next month we'll fill in the other four books of the Law.)

Cumulative recall drill (end of every class)

1. Sing Part A together.
2. Teacher holds up a Bible: "How many books?" (66) "Old?" (39) "New?" (27)
3. "First book?" (Genesis, with the motion) "Spell it!" (G-E-N-E-S-I-S)
4. "What section?" (LAW!)
5. "Genesis 1:1, say it!" (Little Lambs: "In the beginning God created.")
6. Speed round: point at a child and call "Chapter or verse?" while pointing at a big or small number in an open Bible.

Tips for each age group

- **Little Lambs:** Use only Part A and the first two lines of Part B. Lots of motion, little words. Praise loudly!
- **Explorers:** Learn all three parts. Let volunteers lead the "Find It Fast" chant.
- **Trailblazers:** Add a challenge: say the 10 library section names in order (Law, History, Poetry, Major Prophets, Minor Prophets, Gospels, Acts, Paul's Letters, General Letters, Revelation).
- **Ambassadors:** Learn the song well enough to lead it with the Little Lambs. Challenge: say the number of books in each section (5-12-5-5-12 / 4-1-13-8-1).

Spelling & Reading 🔤

Spelling lists by age group

Little Lambs (letters and sounds)	Explorers (book names and story words)	Trailblazers (book names + 5 vocab)	Ambassadors (book names + harder vocab)
G is for **G**enesis and **G**od	GENESIS	GENESIS	GENESIS
B is for **B**ible	BIBLE	TESTAMENT	TESTAMENT
N is for **N**oah	NOAH	CHAPTER	CREATION
A is for **A**dam and **A**braham	ADAM	**Vocab:** CREATION, COVENANT, IMAGE, FAMINE, ARK	**Vocab:** COVENANT, SCRIPTURE, INSPIRATION, PATRIARCH, REDEMPTION
J is for **J**oseph and **J**esus	EVE		
Sound it out: *G-e-n* "Gen"	JOSEPH		
Trace: G-O-D	ABRAHAM		
	VERSE		

Ambassadors vocab with definitions:

- **Covenant:** a binding promise-relationship God makes with people (with Noah in Genesis 9, with Abraham in Genesis 15 and 17).
- **Scripture:** the written Word of God; the 66 books of the Bible.
- **Inspiration:** God guiding the human writers so what they wrote is His Word ("God-breathed," 2 Timothy 3:16).
- **Patriarch:** a "founding father" of God's people: Abraham, Isaac and Jacob.
- **Redemption:** being bought back or rescued; what God does for His people, ultimately through Jesus.

The syllable-clap method 👋

1. Say the word slowly: "Gen... e... sis."
2. Clap once for each part: **Gen** (clap) **e** (clap) **sis** (clap) = 3 claps.
3. Spell each clap-part: "Gen" = G-E-N, "e" = E, "sis" = S-I-S.
4. Put it together: G-E-N-E-S-I-S!
5. Try it on: Ab-ra-ham (3), Jo-seph (2), Tes-ta-ment (3), Cov-e-nant (3), Cre-a-tion (3).

"Spell It Out" relay

- **Setup:** Two or more teams in lines. At the far wall, put a pile of large letter cards for each team (or magnetic letters on a whiteboard).
- **Play:** The teacher calls a word ("GENESIS!"). The first child runs, grabs the first letter, runs back, and tags the next child, who gets the second letter, and so on. The team lines up its letters in order on the floor.
- **Win:** First team to spell it correctly, *and say the word and its section together* ("GENESIS, LAW!"), gets a point.
- **Little Lambs:** Find just the first letter ("Find the G!"). **Ambassadors:** Spell vocab words backwards for a challenge.

Mini spelling bee word list (with sentences)

Word	Use it in a sentence
Genesis	*Genesis* is the first book of the Bible.
Bible	The *Bible* has 66 books.
Testament	The Old *Testament* was written before Jesus was born.
chapter	Genesis has 50 *chapters*.
verse	Genesis 1:1 is the first *verse* in the Bible.
creation	God made everything in the *creation* story.
Abraham	God promised *Abraham* a family as many as the stars.
Isaac	*Isaac* means "he laughs."
Jacob	God changed *Jacob's* name to Israel.
Joseph	*Joseph* forgave his brothers.
rainbow	The *rainbow* reminds us of God's promise.
covenant	God made a *covenant* with Noah.
famine	There was a seven-year *famine* in Egypt.
Egypt	Joseph's family moved to *Egypt*.
patriarch	Abraham was the first *patriarch*.

Read-aloud practice passage (Genesis 1:1–5, NIV)

Have Explorers and older take turns reading one sentence each. Little Lambs repeat after a leader, one phrase at a time.

> "In the beginning God created the heavens and the earth. Now the earth was formless and empty, darkness was over the surface of the deep, and the Spirit of God was hovering over the waters. And God said, 'Let there be light,' and there was light. God saw that the light was good, and he separated the light from the darkness. God called the light 'day,' and the darkness he called 'night.' And there was evening, and there was morning — the first day."

Reading tip: Point out the repeated phrases ("And God said," "God saw that it was good," "there was evening, and there was morning"). Repeated words are clues to what's important!

Word Trivia ❓

⭐ Easy (Little Lambs / Explorers)

1. How many books are in the Bible?
2. What is the first book of the Bible?
3. Who made the world?
4. **True or False:** The Old Testament was written before Jesus was born.
5. What did God make on the very first day?
6. Who built the ark?
7. What did God put in the sky as a promise?
8. Who were the first man and woman?
9. **Fill in the blank:** "In the _____ God created the heavens and the earth."
10. What special gift did Jacob give Joseph?
11. What did God call everything He made? (Two words)
12. **Who said it?** "Where are you?" (Genesis 3:9)

⭐⭐ Medium (Explorers / Trailblazers)

13. How many books are in the Old Testament? In the New Testament?
14. In "John 3:16," what does the 3 stand for? The 16?
15. Where in your Bible can you look to find what page a book starts on?
16. How many days did it rain on Noah's ark?
17. What bird brought Noah an olive leaf?
18. What did God tell Abraham to try to count?
19. How old was Abraham when Isaac was born?
20. **Who said it?** "God himself will provide the lamb." (Genesis 22:8)
21. **True or False:** Joseph's brothers sold him for 20 pieces of silver.
22. What new name did God give Jacob?

23. **Which book?** The story of the Tower of Babel is found in which book?

⭐⭐⭐ Hard (Trailblazers / Ambassadors)

24. What does the word "Genesis" mean?
25. Name the 10 sections of the Bible library in order.
26. Which verse is called the "first gospel" (the first promise of a Savior)?
27. **Fill in the blank:** "You intended to harm me, but God intended it for _____." (Genesis 50:20)
28. What three things did God promise Abraham in Genesis 12?
29. **True or False:** Chapter and verse numbers were in the Bible when it was first written.
30. What three languages was the Bible originally written in?
31. How many chapters are in Genesis?
32. **Who said it?** "Am I my brother's keeper?" (Genesis 4:9)
33. According to Genesis 15:6, why did God count Abram as righteous?
34. How old was Joseph when he entered Pharaoh's service?
35. Who is the traditional author of Genesis?

🔑 Answer Key

1. 66 · 2. Genesis · 3. God · 4. True · 5. Light · 6. Noah · 7. A rainbow · 8. Adam and Eve · 9. beginning · 10. A beautiful, colorful robe (coat) · 11. "Very good" · 12. God
2. 39 Old, 27 New · 14. 3 = chapter, 16 = verse · 15. The Table of Contents · 16. 40 days and 40 nights · 17. A dove · 18. The stars · 19. 100 · 20. Abraham · 21. True (Genesis 37:28) · 22. Israel · 23. Genesis (chapter 11)
3. "Beginning" or "origin" · 25. Law, History, Poetry/Wisdom, Major Prophets, Minor Prophets, Gospels, History (Acts), Paul's Letters, General Letters, Prophecy (Revelation) · 26. Genesis 3:15 · 27. good · 28. Land, a great nation (many descendants), blessing to all peoples on earth through him · 29. False (they were added much later) · 30. Hebrew, Aramaic, Greek · 31. 50 · 32. Cain · 33. Because he believed (trusted) the LORD · 34. 30 (Genesis 41:46) · 35. Moses

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Games 🎮

(More games and variations: `../00-start-here/game-library.md`)

1. Old or New? Run!

- **Best for:** All ages (great for Week 1).
- **Supplies:** Two big signs: "OLD TESTAMENT (39) — Before Jesus" and "NEW TESTAMENT (27) — After Jesus." Tape them on opposite walls.
- **Setup:** Kids stand in the middle of the room.
- **How to play:** Call out a book name or a person ("Genesis!", "Matthew!", "Noah!", "Jesus' birth!", "Psalms!", "Revelation!"). Kids run to the correct wall. For younger kids, use people and events; for older, use book names only.
- **How to win:** Last one to the right wall (or anyone at the wrong wall) does a silly job (5 jumping jacks) and rejoins. Everyone keeps playing.

- **Adaptation:** *Little Lambs:* only "Before Jesus or After Jesus?" with pictures. *Ambassadors:* add a third wall: "Which section?" (they must shout the section).
- **Learning goal:** The two testaments; early familiarity with book names.

2. Draw Your Swords (Bible Address Race)

- **Best for:** Explorers, Trailblazers, Ambassadors (Little Lambs with a buddy).
- **Supplies:** A Bible for every child (same edition if possible), a list of references.
- **Setup:** Kids stand in a line holding Bibles closed at their sides. ("The word of God is... sharper than any double-edged sword," Hebrews 4:12.)
- **How to play:** Leader: "**Attention!**" (Bibles at side.) "**Draw swords!**" (Bible held flat in front, closed.) Leader reads a reference twice: "Genesis 1:1." "**Charge!**" Kids race to find it. The first to put a finger on the verse steps forward and reads it aloud.
- **How to win:** Points for each first find; everyone who finds it gets a cheer.
- **Week 1 references:** Genesis 1:1; Psalm 119:105; John 3:16; Genesis 12:3; Matthew 1:1; Revelation 22:21; 2 Timothy 3:16. **Weeks 2–4:** Genesis 1:27; 1:31; 3:15; 9:13; 15:6; 22:8; 37:3; 50:20.
- **Adaptation:** *Little Lambs:* "Find Genesis!" (front of the Bible) or "Find the big number 1!" *Ambassadors:* no Contents page allowed, or one point off for each peek.
- **Learning goal:** Finding book, chapter and verse; the Table of Contents trick.

3. Creation Day Scramble

- **Best for:** Little Lambs, Explorers.
- **Supplies:** 7 picture signs (Day 1 light, 2 sky and water, 3 land and plants, 4 sun, moon and stars, 5 fish and birds, 6 animals and people, 7 rest), taped around the room.
- **Setup:** Kids start in the center.
- **How to play:** Call "Day 4!" and kids run to the sun/moon/stars sign and act it out (twinkle fingers). Call "Something God made!" ("Fish!") and they run to the right day. "Day 7!" means everyone lies down and rests, and the first person to giggle is the next caller.
- **How to win:** No losers; just fun. For older kids, last one to the correct sign answers a trivia question.
- **Adaptation:** *Older kids:* call the reverse ("What day were the birds?") or call two items fast. *Ambassadors:* explain the days 1–3 / days 4–6 "spaces and fillers" pattern.
- **Learning goal:** The order and goodness of creation.

4. Two by Two Animal Match

- **Best for:** Little Lambs, Explorers.
- **Supplies:** Pairs of animal picture cards (one card per child; make sure every card has a match).
- **Setup:** Give each child a card face down. Don't let them show anyone!
- **How to play:** "Go!" Kids make their animal's sound or motion (no words) to find their partner. When a pair finds each other, they link arms and walk "two by two" into the "ark" (a taped rectangle or blanket area).
- **How to win:** When everyone's in, the teacher "shuts the door" ("God shut them in," Genesis 7:16) and everyone shouts "God keeps His promises!"
- **Adaptation:** *Older kids:* use harder animals (sloth, platypus) or add a timer.

- **Learning goal:** Noah's story; God keeping Noah's family safe.

5. Count the Stars Toss

- **Best for:** All ages.
- **Supplies:** A dark blanket or poster board with paper stars taped on (each star has a number of points, 1–5); beanbags or crumpled paper balls.
- **Setup:** Lay the "night sky" on the floor. Line kids up behind a tape line.
- **How to play:** Each child tosses a beanbag. If it lands on a star, they answer a trivia question (matching the star's difficulty) to earn its points.
- **How to win:** The team with the most points wins, but the twist at the end is: "Did anybody count ALL the stars in the real sky? No! God's promise to Abraham was bigger than we can count!"
- **Adaptation:** *Little Lambs:* just count out loud together the stars they hit. *Ambassadors:* questions from the ⭐⭐⭐ list.
- **Learning goal:** God's promise to Abraham; trivia review.

6. Joseph's Coat Color Relay

- **Best for:** All ages.
- **Supplies:** Strips of colored paper or fabric (many colors), a large paper "coat" outline for each team, tape or glue sticks; a list of review questions.
- **Setup:** Teams line up; coats on the far wall; color strips in a basket by the teacher.
- **How to play:** Teacher asks the first child in line a question. If correct, they take one color strip, run, and tape it on their team's coat. Then the next child goes.
- **How to win:** First team to cover their coat (for example 10 strips) wins, and then shouts Genesis 50:20 together.
- **Adaptation:** *Little Lambs:* name a color to get a strip ("Red!"). *Older kids:* questions about Joseph's life in order, and they must also say the age (17 / 30).
- **Learning goal:** Joseph's story and God's goodness.

7. Library Shelf Sort (bonus for Trailblazers / Ambassadors)

- **Best for:** Trailblazers, Ambassadors (Explorers in teams).
- **Supplies:** 66 index cards, each with one book name; 10 "shelf" signs on the floor (section names).
- **Setup:** Shuffle the cards and split them among teams.
- **How to play:** Teams race to place every card under the correct section sign, in order.
- **How to win:** Fastest correct shelf (check against the Contents page) wins.
- **Adaptation:** *Explorers:* just Old Testament or New Testament piles.
- **Learning goal:** A preview of the whole library structure for the year.

Coloring Pages 🖍️

> Printable book-name coloring sheet and word search: see `../printables/phase-01-printables.html`

Page 1: The Bible Library Bookshelf (Week 1)

- **Scene:** A tall wooden bookshelf with two big doors labeled "OLD TESTAMENT — 39" and "NEW TESTAMENT — 27." Small book spines on the shelves; the first spine says "GENESIS." A smiling child holds a flashlight shining on the shelf.
- **Caption:** *"Your word is a lamp for my feet, a light on my path." Psalm 119:105*
- **Coloring conversation:** "Which room is before Jesus? Which is after? Can you find Genesis on the shelf? What do you want to learn from the Bible this year?"

Page 2: Seven Days of Creation (Week 2)

- **Scene:** A circle divided into 7 pie slices: (1) light and dark, (2) sky and water, (3) land, trees and flowers, (4) sun, moon and stars, (5) fish and birds, (6) animals and two people, (7) a peaceful scene with "REST."
- **Caption:** *"God saw all that he had made, and it was very good." Genesis 1:31*
- **Coloring conversation:** "What's your favorite thing God made? Why do you think God made so many colors? You're made in God's image. What's one way you can show God's kindness?"

Page 3: Noah's Ark and the Rainbow (Week 3)

- **Scene:** The ark resting on a mountain; animals walking out two by two (elephants, giraffes, lions, sheep); Noah's family waving; a dove with an olive leaf; a big rainbow overhead.
- **Caption:** *"I have set my rainbow in the clouds." Genesis 9:13*
- **Coloring conversation:** "What does a rainbow remind us of? What's a promise God has made to you? (He'll never leave you, Hebrews 13:5.)"

Page 4: Abraham Under the Stars (Week 3)

- **Scene:** Abraham as an old man standing outside a tent at night, looking up at a sky FULL of stars; Sarah peeks out of the tent. Leave lots of stars for kids to color or add with glitter.
- **Caption:** *"Look up at the sky and count the stars." Genesis 15:5*
- **Coloring conversation:** "Can you count all the stars? God's family is that big, and you can be part of it through Jesus!"

Page 5: Joseph's Colorful Coat (Week 4)

- **Scene:** Young Joseph holding out his arms to show a long robe with big stripes and patches; in the background a pyramid and a little picture of grain bundles bowing.
- **Caption:** *"God intended it for good." Genesis 50:20*

- **Coloring conversation:** "Use a different color for every stripe! When something bad happens, who is with you? Who can you forgive this week?"

Page 6: GENESIS Bubble Letters (book-name page)

- **Scene:** Big outline letters "G-E-N-E-S-I-S" across the page with a sunrise behind them; small pictures tucked into each letter: G = garden, E = Eve, N = Noah, E = earth, S = stars, I = Isaac, S = sun. Below: "Book 1 of 66 · LAW · Old Testament."
- **Caption:** *"In the beginning God created." Genesis 1:1*
- **Coloring conversation:** "Can you spell it out loud as you color each letter? What section is Genesis in?"

Activities & Crafts ✂️

1. Bible Bookshelf Craft (Week 1)

- **Supplies:** 66 thin craft sticks or paper strips per child (or a printed bookshelf sheet with 66 "spines"), a 9×12 sheet of cardstock, glue, markers. Two colors of sticks (for example 39 brown and 27 blue) is ideal.
- **Steps:** (1) Draw a bookshelf outline on the cardstock. (2) Glue the 39 "Old" sticks on the top shelves and the 27 "New" sticks on the bottom shelves. (3) Write "GENESIS" on the very first stick. (4) Title it "My Bible Library."
- **Age adaptations:** *Little Lambs:* pre-glued shelf; they add 5 sticks and color "GENESIS." *Explorers:* count and glue all 66. *Trailblazers / Ambassadors:* color-code by the 10 sections and write each section name.
- **What it teaches:** The Bible is a library of 66 books in two testaments. Keep the bookshelf at home and color in each book as it's learned this year!

2. "My First Bible Address" Card and Bible Tabs (Week 1)

- **Supplies:** Index cards, markers, stickers; for older kids, small sticky tabs or washi tape.
- **Steps:** (1) On the front, write "Genesis 1:1" big. On the back, draw arrows: "Book → Chapter → Verse." (2) Older kids put a tab on the first page of Genesis, Psalms, Matthew and Revelation in their own Bible as "landmarks," and on the Contents page.
- **Age adaptations:** *Little Lambs:* sticker on the Genesis page of a class Bible. *Ambassadors:* help younger kids place tabs.
- **What it teaches:** How to read and find a Bible reference; using the Contents page.

3. Creation Wheel (Week 2)

- **Supplies:** Two paper plates per child, a brass paper fastener, scissors, crayons. Pre-divide one plate into 7 sections.
- **Steps:** (1) On the bottom plate, draw or glue a picture for each day of creation in its section. (2) Cut a pie-slice "window" out of the top plate and write "Genesis 1" on it. (3) Fasten the plates together in the center. (4) Spin to show each day.

- **Age adaptations:** *Little Lambs:* use stickers and pre-printed pictures. *Trailblazers:* write each day's verse reference. *Ambassadors:* label the "spaces" (days 1–3) and "fillers" (days 4–6).
- **What it teaches:** God created in an orderly, good way.

4. Rainbow Promise Mobile (Week 3)

- **Supplies:** A paper plate cut in half (cloud/arch), crepe paper streamers or ribbons in rainbow colors, cotton balls, glue, a hole punch and string.
- **Steps:** (1) Color the half-plate in rainbow stripes or glue cotton "clouds" on it. (2) Glue streamers hanging down. (3) Write on it: "God keeps His promises! Genesis 9:13." (4) Punch a hole and add string for hanging.
- **Age adaptations:** *Little Lambs:* glue cotton balls and pre-cut streamers. *Older kids:* write a different promise of God on each streamer (Hebrews 13:5; John 14:3; 1 John 1:9; Joshua 1:9).
- **What it teaches:** God is faithful to His promises.

5. Abraham's Star Jar (Week 3, older groups)

- **Supplies:** Clear plastic cups or small jars, small paper stars or star stickers, glitter (optional), markers.
- **Steps:** (1) On some stars, write names of people in your family, church or friends who follow Jesus. (2) Fill the jar. (3) Label: "As many as the stars! Genesis 15:5." (4) Discuss: everyone who trusts Jesus is part of Abraham's family (Galatians 3:7).
- **Age adaptations:** *Little Lambs:* decorate a star with their own name: "I'm in God's family!" *Ambassadors:* write names of people they're praying will come to know Jesus.
- **What it teaches:** God kept His promise to Abraham and is still growing His family.

6. Joseph's Coat Collage (Week 4)

- **Supplies:** Coat outline on cardstock, tissue paper or fabric scraps of many colors, glue sticks, markers.
- **Steps:** (1) Glue colorful scraps all over the coat. (2) On the back, write "But God was with Joseph!" or Genesis 50:20. (3) Older kids: write a hard thing on one side of a scrap and "God can bring good" on the other.
- **Age adaptations:** *Little Lambs:* large pre-cut pieces. *Ambassadors:* make a "Joseph and Jesus" comparison chart on the back.
- **What it teaches:** God is with us in hard times; forgiveness.

7. Genesis Story Timeline Rope (whole month, class project)

- **Supplies:** A long rope or ribbon, clothespins, picture cards (Creation, Adam and Eve, Noah, Babel, Abraham, Isaac, Jacob, Joseph, Egypt).
- **Steps:** Each week, kids clip the new pictures in order. Leave the rope up all year so each phase extends it.
- **Age adaptations:** *Little Lambs:* "What comes next?" *Trailblazers / Ambassadors:* add approximate dates and map locations.
- **What it teaches:** Genesis is the start of one big story that continues through all 66 books.

Word Puzzles 🧩

Word Scramble

Unscramble each word.

#	Scrambled	Hint
1	SNEESGI	First book of the Bible
2	LEIBB	God's book
3	ATTMESENT	Old or New _____
4	RECTHAP	The big number
5	SERVE	The little number
6	HONA	Built the ark
7	WOBNRIA	Sign of God's promise
8	MAHABAR	Father of many
9	CASIA	His name means "he laughs"
10	BOCAJ	Renamed Israel
11	PHOSEJ	Had a colorful coat
12	NEVOTANC	A binding promise
13	TOCREANI	God making everything
14	DENE	The first garden

🔑 **Answers:** 1. GENESIS · 2. BIBLE · 3. TESTAMENT · 4. CHAPTER · 5. VERSE · 6. NOAH · 7. RAINBOW · 8. ABRAHAM · 9. ISAAC · 10. JACOB · 11. JOSEPH · 12. COVENANT · 13. CREATION · 14. EDEN

Fill-in-the-Blank Story

Word bank: 66, beginning, good, rainbow, stars, Isaac, coat, forgave, Contents, Jesus

> The Bible is a library of **(1)** books. If I can't find a book, I look at the **(2)** page. The first book, Genesis, starts with "In the **(3)** God created the heavens and the earth." God looked at everything and said it was very **(4)**. After the flood, God put a **(5)** in the sky. God told Abraham to count the **(6)**. Abraham and Sarah had a baby named **(7)**. Jacob gave Joseph a colorful **(8)**. Joseph's brothers were mean to him, but Joseph **(9)** them. The whole Bible points to **(10)**!

🔑 **Answers:** 1. 66 · 2. Contents · 3. beginning · 4. good · 5. rainbow · 6. stars · 7. Isaac · 8. coat · 9. forgave · 10. Jesus

Match It! (draw a line from the person or thing to its picture or summary)

Person / thing	Picture / summary
1. Genesis	A. 🌈 Built a big boat and saw God's promise in the sky
2. Adam and Eve	B. ⭐ Trusted God and was promised a family like the stars
3. Noah	C. 🧥 Sold by his brothers, saved many lives
4. Abraham	D. 🌅 The book of beginnings, #1 of 66
5. Joseph	E. 🍎 First people; lived in the garden of Eden
6. Old Testament	F. 🪜 Dreamed of a stairway to heaven
7. Jacob	G. 📜 39 books written before Jesus

🔑 **Answers:** 1-D · 2-E · 3-A · 4-B · 5-C · 6-G · 7-F

Questions for Every Age 💭

Little Lambs (4–6)

1. Who made you?
2. What is your favorite thing God made?
3. Is the Bible God's book? (Yes!)
4. What color is your favorite in the rainbow? What does the rainbow remind us of?
5. Was God with Joseph when he was sad? Is God with you when you're sad?

Explorers (7–10)

1. Why do you think God wants us to read the whole Bible, not just parts?
2. What does it mean to be made in God's image?
3. Adam and Eve hid from God after they sinned. What should we do when we sin? (Run *to* God, 1 John 1:9.)
4. Which promise of God do you want to remember this week?
5. Is there someone you need to forgive, like Joseph did?

Trailblazers (11–13)

1. How can 66 books written by about 40 people be one story? What holds it together?
2. Genesis shows good people doing bad things (Abraham lying, Jacob tricking). Why might God include those stories?
3. Where do you see the effects of sin in the world? Where do you see glimpses of God's goodness?
4. Abraham waited 25 years for God's promise (Genesis 12:4; 21:5). What's hardest about waiting on God?

5. Joseph stayed faithful when no one was watching. What does integrity look like for you at school or online?

Ambassadors (14–17)

1. If you believed every person is made in God's image, what would change in how you talk about people?
2. How does knowing the Bible's overall storyline change how you read a single verse?
3. Genesis 3 says sin brought shame and blame. How does Jesus deal with both?
4. Genesis 50:20: can you name a hard time in your life where you later saw God at work?
5. What's one way you can help a younger kid love the Bible this month?

🧠 Big Questions for Ambassadors (apologetics / worldview)

1. **"Doesn't science disprove Genesis?"** *Suggested answer:* Genesis mainly answers *who* made the world and *why* (God, on purpose, for His glory and our good). Science studies *how* the physical world works. Many scientists have been Christians. Christians hold different views on the age of the earth and how to read the days, but they agree that God is Creator, that humans are uniquely made in His image, and that the world is not an accident. The order and fine-tuning of the universe actually fit very well with a Creator (Romans 1:20; Psalm 19:1).
2. **"How can a loving God send a flood?"** *Suggested answer:* A loving God can't be indifferent to evil. Genesis 6:11 says the earth was "full of violence." A good judge stops harm. God was also patient (1 Peter 3:20), gave a way of rescue (the ark), and then promised never to do it again (Genesis 9). The flood shows that sin is serious and that God provides a way to be saved, which points to Jesus.
3. **"Why should I trust that the Bible is God's Word and not just old human writings?"** *Suggested answer:* Look at its unity (one story from 40 authors over 1,500 years), its historical reliability (thousands of ancient manuscripts, archaeology that confirms many places and people), its fulfilled prophecies pointing to Jesus, and above all Jesus Himself, who treated the Old Testament as God's Word (Matthew 5:17–18) and rose from the dead to show He was who He said. The Bible also proves itself in changed lives.

End-of-Phase Review & Celebration 🎉

Review game plan (last Sunday of the month, 75 minutes)

Time	Activity
10 min	Welcome + sing the full Phase 1 song (Parts A–C) with motions
15 min	**Genesis Game Show:** teams answer trivia (⭐ for Little Lambs, ⭐⭐ for Explorers, ⭐⭐⭐ for older) to "build" a giant paper rainbow on the wall, one color per correct answer
10 min	**Sword Drill Championship:** class finals of Draw Your Swords (Little Lambs do "Find Genesis!")

Time	Activity
10 min	**Timeline Rope Race:** teams put Genesis picture cards in order
15 min	**Oral check-offs** (see checklist) while other kids color Page 6
10 min	**Passport stamping & badge ceremony**
5 min	Closing prayer and Take-Home Family Page

Oral check-off checklist

Little Lambs (4–6) ☐ Say "The Bible has 66 books" ☐ Name the first book (Genesis) and show the sunrise motion ☐ Say the section name: "LAW" ☐ Say "In the beginning God created." ☐ Name 3 people from Genesis (for example Adam, Noah, Joseph)

Explorers (7–10) ☐ Say 66 / 39 / 27 ☐ Say AND spell G-E-N-E-S-I-S ☐ Explain chapter versus verse ☐ Find Genesis 1:1 using the Contents page ☐ Say Genesis 1:1 from memory ☐ Name 4 Genesis stories in order

Trailblazers (11–13) ☐ All Explorer items ☐ Name the 10 library sections in order ☐ Give a one-sentence summary of Genesis ☐ Find 3 references in under 30 seconds each ☐ Explain how Genesis 3:15 points to Jesus

Ambassadors (14–17) ☐ All Trailblazer items ☐ Say how many books are in each section ☐ Teach a Little Lamb how to find Genesis 1:1 (with the leader watching) ☐ Explain the two halves of Genesis (1–11 and 12–50) ☐ Share one way Genesis points to Jesus

🛂 Bible Passport stamp

Stamp page 1 of each child's Bible Passport with a **sunrise** stamp (or sticker) labeled: **"Phase 1 ✔ Genesis + The Bible Library · 1 of 66."** Kids who complete their check-off get the stamp; anyone still working can finish next week. Grace, not pressure!

🏅 Phase badge: The Creation Sunrise Badge

A round gold-and-green badge: an open Bible at the bottom with a bright sunrise coming up out of its pages, a small rainbow arching over the top, and the words "IN THE BEGINNING · GENESIS 1:1." Make it from cardstock with a ribbon, a sticker, or an iron-on patch for a sash.

📜 Certificate wording

> **Purpose Church Sunday School Certificate of Completion: Phase 1, "In the Beginning"** This certifies that _____ has explored God's Big Library (66 books, 39 Old Testament, 27 New Testament), learned how to find any book, chapter and verse, and discovered the book of **GENESIS**, where God made everything good and promised a Rescuer. *"In the beginning God*

> *created the heavens and the earth." Genesis 1:1* Books learned: **1 of 66** · Teacher: _____ · Date: _____

Take-Home Family Page 🏠

Dear Parents and Caregivers,

This month your child began a year-long journey through the whole Bible! First we learned how the Bible works: it's a **library of 66 books** (39 Old Testament, 27 New Testament), and we read a reference like "John 3:16" as book, chapter and verse. We also learned the **Table of Contents trick** for finding any book. Then we explored **Genesis**, the book of beginnings: creation, the first sin and God's first promise of a Savior, Noah, Abraham's family, and Joseph. Please help your child practice at home. A few minutes a week makes a big difference!

📖 **Memory verse:** "In the beginning God created the heavens and the earth." (Genesis 1:1, NIV) **Little Lambs:** "In the beginning God created." **Bonus verse:** "Your word is a lamp for my feet, a light on my path." (Psalm 119:105)

🎵 **Our song (tune: *Twinkle, Twinkle, Little Star*):**

> Sixty-six books, one big story, / All about God and all His glory! / Thirty-nine are in the Old, / Twenty-seven New, we're told. / Sixty-six books, one big story, / All about God and all His glory! Genesis is book number one, / That's where God's big story's begun! / G-E-N-E-S-I-S, / God made it all, and it was blessed! / Genesis is book number one, / First of the LAW, and we've begun!

🍽️ **Dinner-table questions:**

1. What's your favorite thing God made? Why?
2. Which promise from God in Genesis do you like best (the rainbow, the stars, the Rescuer)?
3. Joseph forgave his brothers. Is there someone our family needs to forgive?

👨‍👩‍👧 **Family activity: "Family Sword Drill."** Grab every Bible in your house. Call out a reference (Genesis 1:1, Genesis 9:13, Psalm 119:105, John 3:16) and race to find it using the Contents page. Then go outside on a clear night and try to count the stars, and talk about God's promise to Abraham.

📺 **Videos to watch at home** (search these channels on YouTube):

- **@SharefaithKids:** search "Creation," "Noah," "Joseph": `https://www.youtube.com/@SharefaithKids/search?query=Creation`
- **@BibleJourneyTV:** search "Joseph": `https://www.youtube.com/@BibleJourneyTV/search?query=Joseph`
- **@bibleproject:** "Overview: Genesis 1-11" and "Overview: Genesis 12-50": `https://www.youtube.com/@bibleproject/search?query=Genesis`

Next month: Phase 2, "Freedom & God's Good Rules." We'll learn Exodus, Leviticus, Numbers and Deuteronomy, which completes the 5 books of the Law!

For more on the year, see `../00-start-here/program-overview.md` and `../00-start-here/books-of-the-bible-memory-system.md`.